

Li Zhang

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EDUCATION

University of Pittsburgh

Doctor of Philosophy in Intelligent Systems

Pittsburgh, U.S.A.

Aug. 2024 - Apr. 2029

- Research: AI & Law
- Advisor: Prof. [Kevin Ashley](#)
- Courses: Large Language Models (Carnegie Mellon University), Natural Language Processing

Tsinghua University

Master of Computational Law

Beijing, China

Sep. 2019 - Jun. 2022

- Research: Computational Law

Australian National University

Study Abroad in College of Engineering and Computer Science

Canberra, Australia

Jul. 2017 - Dec. 2017

- GPA: 6.5/7.0

China University of Mining and Technology

Bachelor of Electrical Engineering

Jiangsu, China

Sep. 2015 - Jun. 2019

- GPA: 90.91/100, Ranking: 2/278

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

1. Thinking Longer, Not Always Smarter: Evaluating LLM Capabilities in Hierarchical Legal Reasoning

[\[Link\]](#)

Li Zhang, Matthias Grabmair, Morgan Gray, Kevin Ashley

CS&Law 2026

2. PLawBench: A Rubric-Based Benchmark for Evaluating LLMs in Real-World Legal Practice [\[Link\]](#)

Yuzhen Shi, Huanghai Liu, Yiran Hu, Song gaojie, Xu Xinran, Yubo Ma, Tianyi Tang, Li Zhang, Qingjing Chen, Feng Di, Wenbo Lv, Weiheng Wu, Kexin Yang, Sen Yang, Wei Wang, Rongyao Shi, Qiuyuan Yang, Yuemeng Qi, Jingwen Zhang, Xiaoyu Sui, Yifan Chen, Yi Zhang, An Yang, Bowen Yu, Dayiheng Liu, Junyang Lin, Weixin Shen, Bing Zhao, Charles Clarke, Hu Wei

ACL 2026, under review

3. DenseMixer: Improving MoE Post-Training with Precise Router Gradient [\[Link\]](#)

Feng Yao, Junxia Cui, Ruohan Zhang, Liyuan Liu, Shibo Hao, Li Zhang, Chengyu Dong, Shuohang Wang, Yelong Shen, Jianfeng Gao, Jingbo Shang

ICML 2026, under review

4. Do LLMs Truly Understand When a Precedent Is Overruled? [\[Link\]](#)

Li Zhang, Jaromir Savelka, Kevin Ashley

JURIX 2025, Best Student Paper

5. Mitigating Manipulation and Enhancing Persuasion: A Reflective Multi-Agent Approach for Legal Argument Generation [\[Link\]](#)

Li Zhang, Kevin Ashley

ICAIL 2025

6. Measuring Faithfulness and Abstention: An Automated Pipeline for Evaluating LLM-Generated 3-ply Case-Based Legal Arguments [\[Link\]](#)

Li Zhang, Morgan Gray, Jaromir Savelka, Kevin Ashley

ICAIL 2025

7. Generating Case-Based Legal Arguments with LLMs [\[Link\]](#)

Morgan Gray, Li Zhang, Kevin Ashley

CS&Law 2025

TALKS

1. Do LLMs Truly Understand When a Precedent Is Overruled, [2025 Pittsburgh Legal AI Summit](#), Carnegie Mellon University
2. Mitigating Manipulation and Enhancing Persuasion: A Reflective Multi-Agent Approach for Legal Argument Generation, [ResearchTrend.AI](#)
3. Enhancing Legal Argument Generation: From Basic Schemes to Trustworthy Multi-Agent Systems, [ISP Forum](#), University of Pittsburgh

PROJECTS

- | | |
|---|----------------------------|
| Benchmarking LLM Long-Context Understanding and Temporal Logic | Pittsburgh, U.S.A |
| <i>Li Zhang, Jaromir Savelka, Kevin Ashley</i> | <i>Sep. 2024 – Present</i> |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Constructed a high-stakes benchmark dataset from real-world legal corpora to rigorously evaluate LLMs' ability to comprehend long-context documents and track complex overruling relationships.• Analyzed temporal biases and hallucinations in model outputs, developing specific metrics to ensure AI-generated case histories accurately reflect the temporal dynamics of legal precedents. | |
| Reflective Multi-Agent Frameworks for Ethical Legal Persuasion | Pittsburgh, U.S.A |
| <i>Li Zhang, Kevin Ashley</i> | <i>Aug. 2024 – Present</i> |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Architected a multi-agent AI system employing reflective verification processes, where separate agents critique and verify generated arguments against factual records to minimize hallucination.• Implemented ethical guardrails to ensure AI assistants advocate effectively without manipulating facts or fabricating evidence, aligning system outputs with professional legal standards. | |
| Evaluating and Enhancing Hierarchical Legal Reasoning | Pittsburgh, U.S.A |
| <i>Li Zhang, Matthias Grabmair, Morgan Gray, Kevin Ashley</i> | <i>Nov. 2024 – Present</i> |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Investigated the phenomenon of reasoning collapse in LLMs, specifically evaluating their performance in multi-stage legal reasoning tasks that require distinguishing cases based on subtle factual predicates.• Developed hierarchical inference strategies to enhance the robustness of legal AI, improving the model's ability to perform nuanced logical deductions in complex case law scenarios. | |

LEGAL EXPERIENCE

The Export-Import Bank of China, Nanjing, China

Legal Counselor, Jun. 2022 - Jun. 2024

Spearheaded legal negotiations for complex banking transactions, ensuring strict adherence to regulatory compliance and risk mitigation strategies. Drafted and reviewed extensive credit facility agreements and security documents to safeguard the bank's interests in cross-border financing. Collaborated with internal stakeholders to provide strategic legal counsel on operational risks and dispute resolution matters.

SKILLS & QUALIFICATIONS

- **Programming:** Python (PyTorch, Scikit-learn, Pandas and NumPy), SQL, JavaScript
- **Cloud Technologies:** SageMaker, DynamoDB and API Gateway
- **Legal:** PRC Legal Professional Qualification
- **Others:** L^AT_EX, Markdown, Linux, Shell and Anaconda

SELECTED AWARDS & HONORS

- SCI Fellowship, University of Pittsburgh, 2024
- Dean's List (top 1%), Tsinghua Law School, 2022
- Law School Fellowship, Tsinghua Law School, 2021
- Dean's List (top 1%), China University of Mining and Technology, 2019